



JAY L. CLENDENIN Los Angeles Times

SYMPHONY OF STEEL

Pritzker Prize winner Frank Gehry changed the face of downtown Los Angeles’ Grand Avenue with the wavy Walt Disney Concert Hall and, later, the Grand LA complex, which he’s shown visiting in 2022.

Panel drops newborn shot for hep B

Over objections, a CDC committee votes to stop recommending vaccination at birth.

By SONJA SHARP AND CORINNE PURTILL

A key vaccine advisory panel for the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention voted Friday to drop a decades-old recommendation to vaccinate all newborns against hepatitis B, the committee’s most controversial decision since its overhaul by Health and Human Services Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. in June.

The Advisory Committee on Immunization Practices voted 8 to 3 to adopt “individual-based decision making” for the newborn hep B vaccine dose for babies born to women who test negative, as are more than 99% of babies born in the U.S.

The move was met with condemnation by physicians and public health officials, including some on the committee. The CDC has recommended the shot since 1991, resulting in a 99% decline in rates of chronic hepatitis B infections in children and teens.

“‘Do no harm’ is a moral imperative. We are doing harm by changing this wording,” said Dr. Cody Meissner, an expert in pediatric infectious diseases at Dartmouth-Hitchcock Medical Center, who cast one of the few dissenting votes.

“This has a great potential to cause harm, and I simply hope the committee will accept this responsibility when that harm is caused,” said fellow no-vote Dr. Joseph Hibbeln, a psychiatrist formerly with the National Institutes of Health.

The committee spent the rest of Friday discussing the childhood and adolescent [See Hepatitis B, A9]

FRANK GEHRY, 1929 – 2025

Visionary architect transformed skylines

He designed ebullient cultural landmarks in L.A. and beyond with late-career revolution

By CHRISTOPHER HAWTHORNE

Architect Frank O. Gehry, who brought an alluringly new kind of shape-making to his profession even as he fundamentally changed the reputation and civic landscape of his adopted hometown of Los Angeles in such projects as the shimmering Walt Disney Concert Hall on Grand Avenue, has died. He was 96.

Gehry, who arrived in L.A. as an aimless teenager just after World War II and went on to become the most famous and one of the most influential architects in the world over a prolific six-decade career, died Friday at his home in Santa Monica following a brief respiratory illness, Gehry Partners chief of staff Meaghan Lloyd confirmed to The Times.

Gehry had been widely respected among L.A. architects since the 1970s, but his global fame grew from high-level pro-

ductivity late in his career. This phase, in which his firm, Gehry Partners, pioneered new ways of using technology to help realize geometrically complex buildings, began with the completion of an ambitious satellite branch of the Guggenheim Museum in Bilbao, Spain. It opened to the public in 1997, the year Gehry turned 68.

The museum was widely praised for its breathtaking and sinuous profile and dramatic relationship to the Nervión River at its feet. Just as important, it helped reenergize and bring new media attention to architecture. Still looking for direction after the breakdown of the Modern movement and the repeated false starts of a historically minded Postmodernism, the profession badly needed a boost.

The new Guggenheim suggested a fresh, dynamic direction: architecture whose appeal resided in the ravishing large-scale curves made possible with [See Gehry, A6]

10 buildings that knew how to misbehave in the best way

Bold works reimagined urban design in the U.S. and abroad

By SAM LUBELL



SERGI REBOREDO VW Pics / Universal Images Group via Getty Images
FRANK GEHRY’S renowned Guggenheim Museum Bilbao in Spain was completed in 1997.

Frank Gehry, who died Friday at 96, challenged the notion that buildings needed to behave themselves — creating artful, strange, kinetic combinations of structure, material, form and light, and transforming cities in the process. Here are 10 of his most famous structures that pushed the boundaries of architecture, culture, taste and technology.

Guggenheim Museum Bilbao, Bilbao, Spain, 1997

While only one piece of a much larger urban transformation, this uproarious structure, perched at the edge of the Basque city’s industrial waterfront, utterly [See Buildings, A7]

APPRECIATION: No one did more than Gehry to benefit modern music. **A8**

Democrats unveil an affordable housing plan

Schiff and others focus on rising cost of living, as Trump calls the issue a ‘con job.’

By ANA CEBALLOS

WASHINGTON — As the economy emerges as a likely defining issue in next year’s midterm elections, President Trump has wrestled with Americans’ rising

cost of living, declaring himself the “affordability president,” then soon dismissing the issue as something that “does not mean anything to anybody.”

At two White House events this week, the president accused Democrats of pushing a “fake narrative” about affordability to trick voters ahead of the election, calling them “great con people” who do not offer details about how they intend to lower prices.

“It’s a con job. I think affordability is the greatest con job,” Trump said Wednesday.

Meanwhile, Democrats on Capitol Hill are moving to shape an affordability-focused agenda ahead of the midterms, including a proposal to address rising housing costs.

Sen. Adam Schiff (D-Calif.) is expected to introduce legislation Monday aimed at increasing the supply of affordable housing for low-

and middle-income families, expanding rental assistance, and boosting funding for long-term housing and emergency homeless shelters, according to a draft copy of the bill reviewed by The Times.

“Of all the affordability challenges Americans face, housing is the most acute. This is certainly the case in California, but it’s true across much of the country,” Schiff said in an interview. “I [See Affordability, A9]

Netflix to buy Warner Bros. in historic deal

Critics say takeover would harm theaters, consumers and film industry workers.

By MEG JAMES

First, Netflix upended Hollywood. Now, the streaming giant is buying a historic piece of it.

Netflix prevailed in a contentious bidding war to buy Warner Bros., agreeing to pay \$72 billion for the storied Burbank film and television studios, its spacious lot, HBO and the HBO Max streaming service.

The two companies announced the blockbuster deal early Friday, a proposed baton pass that would give Netflix such beloved characters as Batman, Harry Potter, Jon Snow and Fred Flintstone.

“Warner Bros. has some of the best entertainment in the world,” Netflix Co-Chief Executive Ted Sarandos said during a conference call with Wall Street analysts. “The combination of Netflix and Warner Bros. creates a better Netflix for the long term. It sets us up for success for decades to come.”

Netflix’s cash and stock transaction is valued at about \$27.75 per Warner Bros. Discovery share. Net-

\$72 billion

Amount Netflix has agreed to pay for Warner Bros. studios, lot and HBO and HBO Max.

\$10 billion

Approximate Warner Bros. debt Netflix has also agreed to take on.

300 million

Subscribers that Netflix has, leading all streaming services worldwide.

128 million

Subscribers Warner Bros. Discovery has.

flix also agreed to take on more than \$10 billion in Warner Bros. debt, pushing the deal’s enterprise value to \$82.7 billion.

Netflix shares closed at \$100.24 Friday.

Buying a studio that dates back 102 years to the silent picture era represents a major strategic shift for the Los Gatos, Calif., firm. Netflix sputtered to life in 1997 by buying movie DVDs and mailing them in red envelopes to customers.

[See Netflix, A12]

Sarandos’ steady rise in Hollywood

Warner acquisition is a moment of triumph for a film buff who has defied convention.

By WENDY LEE AND MEG JAMES

Hollywood moguls once dismissed the outsize ambitions of Netflix’s executives.

“Is the Albanian army going to take over the world?” former Time Warner Chairman Jeff Bewkes asked a reporter 15 years ago. “I don’t think so.”

Think again. On Friday, Netflix co-Chief Executive Ted Sarandos pulled off an audacious \$82-billion deal to buy much of Bewkes’ old haunts: the Warner Bros. film and TV studios in Burbank, and HBO and the HBO Max streaming service in Culver City.

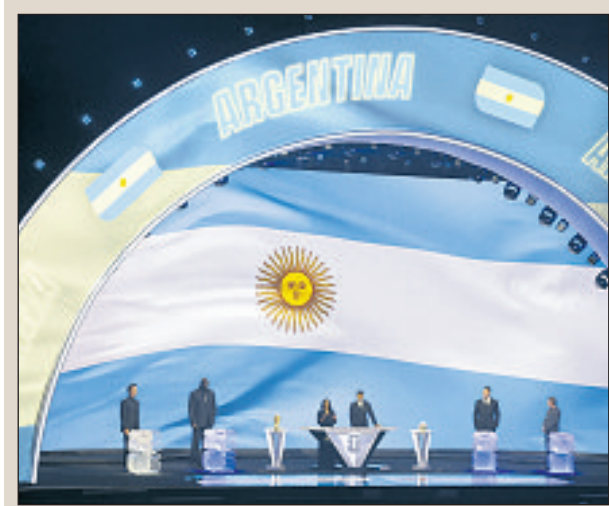
“This is a rare opportuni-

ty,” Sarandos said in an investor call. “It’s going to help us achieve our mission to entertain the world and to bring people together through great stories. We’ve built a great business, and to do that, we’ve had to be bold and continue to evolve.”

If the takeover is approved — it could face a raft of legal and regulatory challenges — Netflix would gain ownership of such classics as “Casablanca” and “Goonies” and popular characters including “Batman,” “Scooby-Doo,” “Dirty Harry” and “Harry Potter.”

The acquisition represents a moment of triumph for the brash Sarandos, who has gone from Hollywood gate-crasher to the ultimate power broker.

“There seems to be no ceiling of opportunity for Ted Sarandos,” said Tom Nunan, a former studio and network executive. “He’s the [See Sarandos, A11]



KEVIN DIETSCH Getty Images

WORLD CUP TAKES STAGE

Tom Brady, Shaquille O’Neal, Aaron Judge and Wayne Gretzky serve as draw assistants as the groups are revealed in Washington. **SPORTS, B12**

Justices to hear citizenship case

Trump plan would end birthright protection for children of people in the country illegally or temporarily. **NATION, A3**

Weather

Sunny.

L.A. Basin: 71/48. **B8**

Markets **A12**

Opinion Voices **A13**

FEMA rejects Newsom meeting

The governor renews calls for billions in federal fire recovery aid. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

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